Handbooks, Manuals, etc.

H 1646

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A. Background

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. General rule

Use ***--Handbooks, manuals, etc.*** as a free-floating form subdivision under subject headings of all types for concise reference works in which facts and information pertaining to the topic are arranged for ready reference and consultation rather than for continuous reading and study.

LC practice: Assign a subject heading for the topic of the work. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g., ***Handbooks and manuals***.

Example:

```
650 ## $a Technology $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.
```

LC practice:

```
650 ## $a Technology.
655 #7 $a Handbooks and manuals. $2 lcgft
```

Example:

```
651 #0 $a Middle East $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.
```

LC practice

```
651 #0 $a Middle East.
655 #7 $a Handbooks and manuals. $2 lcgft
```

Example:

```
610 20 $a Library of Congress $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.
```

LC practice:

```
610 20 $a Library of Congress.
655 #7 $a Handbooks and manuals. $2 lcgft
```

Example:

```
630 00 $a WordPerfect (Computer file) $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.
```

LC practice:

```
630 00 $a WordPerfect (Computer file)
655 #7 $a Handbooks and manuals. $2 lcgft
```

Example

```
600 10 $a Dickinson, Emily, $d 1830-1886 $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.
```

LC practice:

```
600 10 $a Dickinson, Emily, $d 1830-1886
655 #7 $a Handbooks and manuals. $2 lcgft
```

D. Classes of persons

Use the subdivision under classes of persons only if a heading for the corresponding field or activity does not exist and cannot be established, for example, ***Nurses' aides--Handbooks, manuals, etc.***

LC practice: Assign a subject heading for the topic of the work. Use a class of persons heading if the field or activity does not exist and cannot be established. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g., ***Handbooks and manuals***.

E. Other subdivisions

Use more specific free-floating form subdivisions where appropriate, including:

Form subdivision	SHM Manual
$v Amateurs' manuals	Consult H 1943.5, section 4.

$v Guidebooks	Consult 1645.
$v Laboratory manuals	
$v Observers' manuals	
$v Tables	Consult H 2160.

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.